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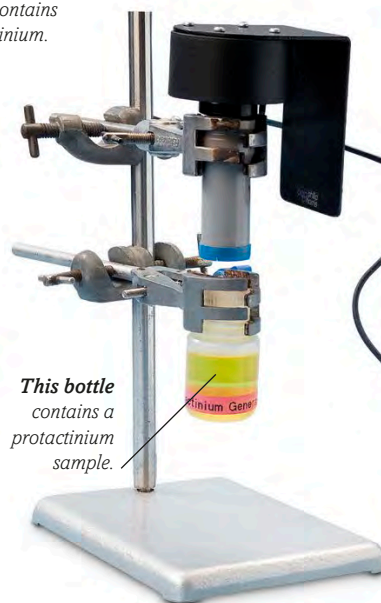
Protactinium

This vibrant green radioactive mineral contains tiny amounts of protactinium.

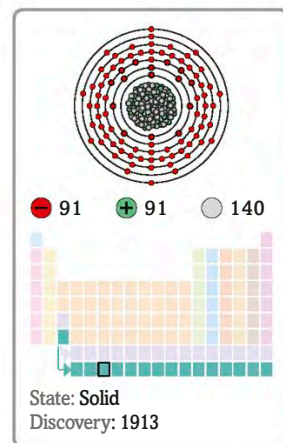


Torbernite

This brittle, shiny ore feels waxy.



This bottle contains a protactinium sample.



A Geiger counter measures the sample's radioactivity.

Protactinium research

The name **protactinium** means “**before actinium**”. This is because a uranium atom decays to form a protactinium atom, which then quickly breaks down into an actinium atom. Small quantities of protactinium are found in ancient sands and mud. Geologists use Geiger counters to carry out **research** to calculate how old the sands are.

These used nuclear fuel rods contain protactinium.



Nuclear waste